

6.3 Political cartoon analysis

Political cartoons are visual commentaries that use symbolism, exaggeration, and humour to express opinions about political, social, or environmental issues. They are helpful in Geography as they communicate complex geographical ideas, such as resource use, environmental challenges, global inequalities, and geopolitical relationships, in a quick and accessible way.

Select one of the provided political cartoons and complete the activities and questions below using it.

1. Annotate the political cartoon to explain its meaning. When annotating, you might explain:
 - a. Symbols: What objects or characters represent (e.g., a melting globe symbolising climate change).
 - b. Exaggeration: Features that are drawn oversized or distorted to make a point.
 - c. Labels: Any words included and what they contribute to the message.
 - d. Caricature: How people or groups are visually exaggerated to communicate a stance.

2. What is happening in the cartoon? Describe it in your own words.

3. Who are the main characters or objects in the cartoon, and why might the cartoonist have chosen them?

4. Where in the world is this issue taking place? Is it local, national, or global?

5. Does the cartoon use humour, irony, or exaggeration? How?

6. What human or environmental impacts are shown or suggested in the cartoon?

7. How might different people around the world react to this cartoon?

8. Whose perspective is shown most strongly; the government, the public, the environment, businesses, or another group?

9. What perspectives are missing from the cartoon?

10. Do you agree with the viewpoint presented? Why or why not?

11. Optional extension: What alternative cartoon could you draw to show a different viewpoint?



